Your questions will drive the analysis phase by providing a lens with which to view this data. Through this lens you can identify data points and metrics that help answer your questions. These data points then become the indicators of progress as you adjust your process to get to an ideal operating model for your team. Once you have questions you want to answer, then you can start identifying data points and metrics that represent them. At that point you can adjust how your team operates and track the metrics you've identified.

1.1.1. What are metrics?

> *"A method of measuring something, or the results obtained from this."*
>
> *metrics defined by Google*

In the scope of this book metrics will represent the data you can get from your application lifecycle as it applies to the performance of software development teams. A metric can come from a single data source or it can be a combination of data from multiple data sources. Any data point that you track eventually becomes a metric that you can use to measure your team's performance. Examples of common metrics are:

- ***Velocity*** —The relative performance of your team over time
- ***Changed lines of code (CLOC)*** —The number of lines of code that were changed over time

Metrics can be used to measure anything you think is relevant, which can be a powerful tool when used to facilitate better communication and collaboration. These metrics in effect become key performance indicators (KPIs) that help measure what's important to your team and your business.

Using KPIs and data trends to show how certain data points affect behaviors and progress, you can tweak the behavior of your team and watch how the changes you make affect data that's important to it.

1.2. Why agile teams struggle with measurement